



GOOGLE DRIVE

VS

MICROSOFT OFFICE 365

VS

APPLE iWORK



The battle to be the office suite in the cloud has never been more hotly contested. It's not as straightforward as it seems either

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It wasn't too long ago that Microsoft Office was the only viable alternative when it came to a productivity suite on the PC. Today, Office, while still popular, is only one of the suites that you can opt for when you want to work with documents, spreadsheets and presentations. Google Drive has jumped the line in terms of popularity and is almost as ubiquitous as Office was back in its heydays and, thanks to the overwhelming user base of iDevices, Apple's iWork (that's made up of three separate software – Pages, Numbers and Keynote) has also made its presence felt in all manner of tech products such as desktops, laptops, tablets and phones.

That's why it really isn't a long shot to imagine that plenty of users would be confused about which suite to opt for. So, let's get down to helping you decide:

(Note: To remove any confusion, we will be talking about Office 365 and not Office 2013 – both are pretty much the same except for the fact that Office 365 requires an annual subscription while Office 2013 requires a one-time payment).

Core features

Microsoft Office has always been top-dog when it comes to features and Office 365 offers the full-featured versions of the most popular Office software including Word, Excel and PowerPoint (and also OneNote, Outlook, Publisher and Access). If you've ever used Office before, you know that you can't beat it in terms of the options it provides with respect to working with files. If you've subscribed to Office 365 (or own a Windows Phone), then you also get access to Office Mobile, which is a pared down version of the desktop suite – with limited format-

ting options and inability to create presentations.

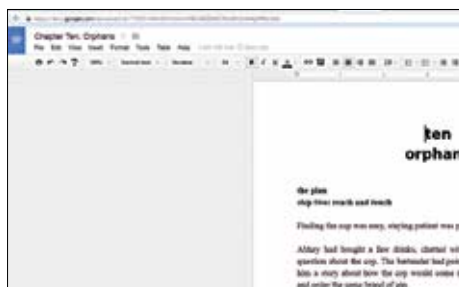
Google Drive almost seems lightweight when compared to Office 365. While basic users probably won't miss much when working on Drive, they might feel slightly frustrated if they're used to Office, on account of the lack of formatting options, templates, etc. Like with Office, the Drive mobile app is a 'lite' version of the actual service and does not allow you to create presentations.

Apple's iWork is kind of like the midway point between Office and Drive. It offers more features than Drive but not as much as the Microsoft software. It offers the standard software for documents, presentations and spreadsheets (Pages, Keynote and Numbers) and all of these software also have their mobile app versions for the iPhone and the iPad.

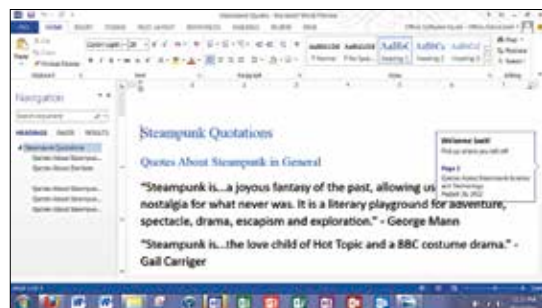
Score: Office365 1 - Drive 0 - iWork 0

Price

Office 365 can be yours for ₹4,199 a year. This will let you install Office on five devices



Some will like Google Drive's basic, minimalistic interface while some may find it lacking.



As always, every component of Office 365 (Word shown above) is chock full of features, many of which you will never use.

whether they be phones, tablets, laptops or desktops.

The three components that make up iWork each cost ₹1,100 (for the Mac) and ₹550 (for iOS) and can be installed any number of times on any number of devices with the same iTunes ID. However, if you've bought a new iDevice or Mac, the entire iWork suite is yours for free.

Google Drive is, as expected, unconditionally free and thus the winner here.

Score: Office365 1 - Drive 1 - iWork 0

Cloud integration

Office 365 uses SkyDrive as its cloud solution which means that all you need to do is install the SkyDrive app on your desktop (Windows or Mac), or phone/tablet (iOS, Android or Windows Phone) and you'll be able to access the files created under the same ID. In Windows or Mac, installing SkyDrive will create a new folder where all the files you want to access on the cloud can be saved. In a step that's quite confusing, using SkyDrive online (through Outlook.com) lets you edit and create spreadsheets, documents and presentations. Now, remember